



The way in which representations make claims about realism.

Issue 6, 'Body Movements', is published in partnership with the **NIKE LONDON GRANT INITIATIVE**, a project that specifically aims to assist Black people challenge racism by funding projects that promote health and well-being, arts and culture, education and sports. Several articles promote the work being done by charities who have benefited from this 2021 project: *Just Doing It*, *Black Companies Making Change*. They feature ordinary people in ordinary places, in areas of London that are particularly socially deprived, such as the Dwaynatics Boxing Club in Brixton, the Peckham Theatre project and the Baytree Centre for girls.

One article promotes the **S.M.I.L.E-ing Boys Project**, which aims to change negative stereotypical media images of young Black men through art. The boys are interviewed as named individuals, photographed in their everyday environment, the effect of which is to humanise them, make us feel closer and identify with them. The aim of the project is *'to empower young Black boys by providing tangible coping strategies to manage their mental health, through workshops, activities and field trips.'*¹⁰



Image by @ejatushaw / Thiiirdmagazine.co.uk
Caption: The S.M.I.L.E-ing Boys Project

Theoretical perspectives

Theories of representation – Stuart Hall

THIIIRD magazine goes against stereotyping as its project is to counter ideas of 'otherness' and present 'togetherness.' Because of inequalities of power, THIIIRD amplifies those groups who have been 'othered' previously. In a collective embrace, it invites us to share as a community, to identify and feel empathy, by understanding other peoples' perspective; not othering them but seeing everyone as part of our community.

Theories of identity – David Gauntlett

THIIIRD celebrates diversity through culture and heritage, race and gender. The podcast often starts with the group of THIIIRD presenters, describing their individual identities, so the audience can place how they may identify with them. Look for your own examples from the magazine website to explore how THIIIRD offers a more diverse range of icons and characters from whom we can 'pick and mix' aspects of our identity. You could use these examples as a basis to practice the type of exam question that asks you how far you can apply the theory here to evaluate Gauntlett's theory.

Feminist theory – bell hooks

Although bell hooks' feminist theory is not one of the set theorists for this set product, it is a valuable text to explore the critical idea of intersectionality: the idea that race and class, as well as sex, determine the extent to which individuals are discriminated against or oppressed. THIIIRD defines itself as an intersectional feminist magazine, embracing all those unheard voices that have been marginalised by the hegemonic ideologies of the group in dominant power positions. Instead, THIIIRD reclaims and celebrates that third space where the discourse of many cultures, languages and heritages intersect.

¹⁰ THIIIRD Instagram 12.11.2022